INDIAN MILITARY'S DIRECT HITS

A commitment to indigenisation and acquiring cutting-edge technology can close the gap with China

HOW INDIAN & CHINESE MILITARIES COMPARE

CHINA
INDIA

MILITARY PERSONNEL

2.2 MN 1.4 MN

MULTIPLE ROCKET LAUNCHERS

2,650 266

WARSHIPS (approx)

370

Projection: Plans to get a mammoth fleet of 435 warships by 2035

150

Projection: Plans to build 200 vessels by 2050

MAIN BATTLE TANKS

6,300

Projection: Increased numbers of Type 600A, Type 15 tanks

4,750

Projection: 1,770 Future Ready Combat Vehicles (FRCA)

COMBAT AIRCRAFT

1,600

Projection: Increased production of advanced jets like J20 stealth fighters

750

Projection: IAF to procure 350 more aircraft over next 2 decades, including 5th generation AMCA stealth fighters

EXPENSES FOR ARSENALS

Top military spenders in 2023, including Pakistan

Military Spend (US $ billion)
% of GDP

US	CHINA	RUSSIA	INDIA	SAUDI ARABIA	PAKISTAN
916	296	109	84	76	9
3.4%	1.7%	5.9%	2.4%	7.1%	2.8%

EXPORTING FIREPOWER

Reflecting increasing global acceptance of Indian defence products and technologies

India's defence exports (Rs crore)

FY 23	FY 24	FY 29
15,920	21,083 (↑32.5%)	50,000+ India's Target by FY 2029

↘ In contrast, China's share of global arms exports has shrunk from 5.6 per cent (2014-2018) to 5.2 per cent (2019-2023) Value of export in 2022: $3.24 billion. Quality issues are said to be the reason

↘ Private sector contributed 60 per cent of India's defence exports in FY 2023-2024

↘ Indian defence equipment exported to 10 countries; China supplies weapons to over 53 nations

MODERNISING THE ARMED FORCES ENTAILS TECHNICAL UPGRADATION, A PUSH TOWARDS INDIGENISATION, AND INTEGRATING AI AND CYBER WARFARE CAPABILITIES

and win future wars on borrowed technology", thus indicating India's worrisome dependence on foreign armaments. A reversal of this trend in recent years—indigenous production under initiatives like 'Make in India'—has been encouraging and is crucial for reducing dependency on foreign arms imports.

AATMANIRBHARTA IN DEFENCE

There has been a marked improvement in India's domestic defence production in the past decade. In FY24, it was valued at Rs 1.27 lakh crore, a record high and a 16.7 per cent increase over the previous year. It was, in fact, the second year in a row that India's defence production surpassed Rs 100,000 crore. Private sector companies contributed 21 per cent of the total or Rs 26,506 crore. As per defence ministry data, more than 14,000 MSMEs and close to 350 start-ups are engaged in defence production in India. The government has set an annual defence production target of Rs 300,000 crore by FY29, which would be an over three-fold jump from current levels. To help defence production, the government liberalised the defence foreign direct investment (FDI) regime by enhancing the earlier foreign equity cap from a maxi-